

SPECIAL-PURPOSE GUNS

Special-purpose firearms range from those designed for personal defence, such as the Dolne Apache Pistol which combines a revolver, dagger, and knuckle-duster, to silenced weapons intended for clandestine operations. Also in this category are single-shot, large-bore pistols that fire pyrotechnic smoke cartridges for signaling, or flares to illuminate a night sky.

► DOLNE APACHE PISTOL

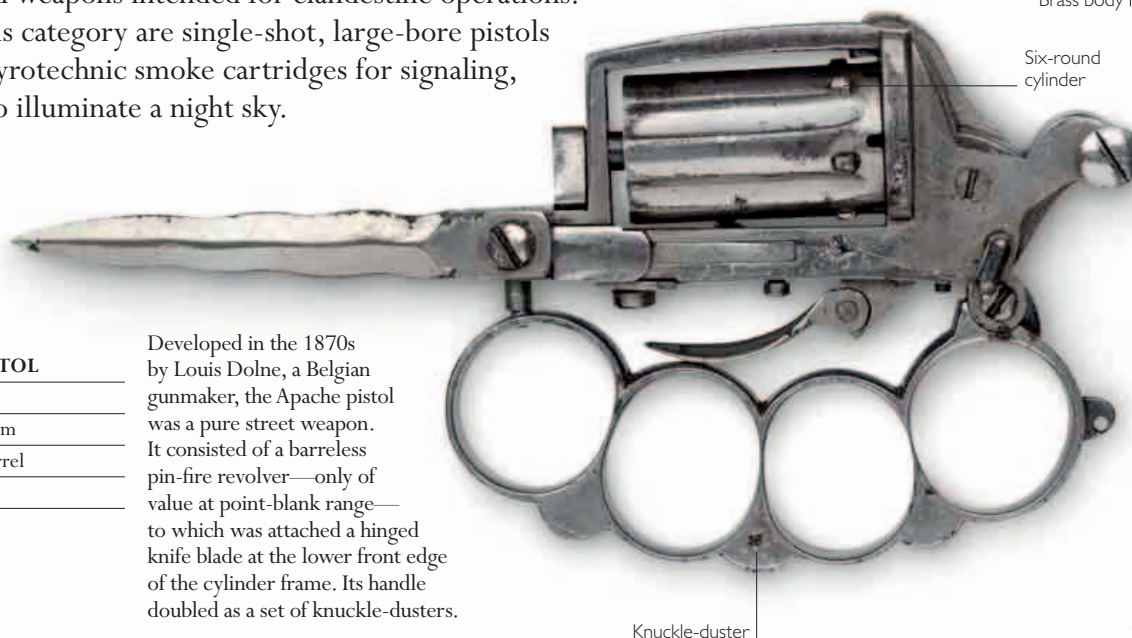
Date 1890

Origin Belgium

Barrel No barrel

Caliber 7mm

Developed in the 1870s by Louis Dolne, a Belgian gunmaker, the Apache pistol was a pure street weapon. It consisted of a barreless pin-fire revolver—to which was attached a hinged knife blade at the lower front edge of the cylinder frame. Its handle doubled as a set of knuckle-dusters.



Knuckle-duster



▲ WEBLEY AND SCOTT FLARE PISTOL

Date 1882–1919

Origin UK

Barrel 4in (10cm)

Caliber 1in

Visual signals are an important means of communicating during military actions. This was never more the case than during World War I, when the din of battle was ever-present. Breaking open for loading like a shotgun, this brass Webley and Scott Flare Pistol could fire smoke charges or flares to illuminate the battlefield at night.



27MM FLARE CARTRIDGE



FLARE CARTRIDGE PACKET

▲ FLARE PISTOL

Date 1907

Origin Germany

Barrel 4in (10¼cm)

Caliber 27mm

This flare pistol is of simple steel and wood construction. The firing mechanism consists of a sprung cocking handle, which acts as a firing pin when released by the trigger.